

The automatic weather station mast at Maitri was inspected on 14 January 2026. Ice loading on the cross arms had increased since the previous visit, so every fastener was checked and the de-icing sleeve around the anemometer was replaced.

The anemometer was recalibrated against the reference cup anemometer carried by the field team. Readings agreed within four per cent across the full range, and the calibration sheet is filed with this log. The wind vane bearing was cleaned and re-greased because the tail had started to stick in rime conditions.

Power came from the solar array with the battery bank holding charge overnight. One panel had a thin coating of settled snow, which was brushed off; no other fault was found on the mast during this visit.

Follow-up: the de-icing sleeve should be inspected again before the next winter season, since the same component had to be replaced twice in the previous two years.